Trang Ngo

Mrs. Hausey

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Written Assignment 1

1. **The first task will be to introduce yourself and let me know what your background is in music and online learning. Give your name, if you play (or have played) an instrument or sing, and if you've ever taken an online class.**
   - My name is Trang Ngo and I am an incoming freshman at California State Fullerton. I plan to pursue a bachelor of Science degree in Computer Science. I personally have little background in music because I have been in choir in my high school freshman year. I always register for online summer classes to catch up the level of learning and fulfill the credit of my high school transcript. Also my senior year was fully online so I am pretty familiar with online classes.
2. **Explain why you have decided to take Music Appreciation online, and what two things you would like to get out of this class by the end of the course (besides a good grade).**
   - I decided to take Music Appreciation online because I am curious about the history of music and the development of music. I have always been passionate about music, especially Hamilton the musical since the beats are very innovative and catchy. By the end of this class, I would love to have more knowledge about different kinds of music and recognize the emotion of composers. Second, I want to sing better such as clearly showing the high or low melody.
3. **Part One in the book discusses the elements of music, including musical form. Find a song that you like that utilizes binary, ternary, or call and response form. Make sure you indicate the song title, artist, and how the song matches one of those forms.**
   - Baa Baa Black Sheep is written by a Swedish music teacher named Alice Tegner. The original song is Bä, bä, vita lamm. I think it is ternary form because the phrase is repeated the same melody and it extends the idea of tax on wool during thirteen century and departure by bringing back the first section
4. **After reading and listening to the examples in the first few chapters, you have hopefully gained a little better understanding of pitch, range, and tone with instruments and voices. Describe the many varieties of musical sounds possible from the human voice. Be sure to consider issues such as range, social function, historical period, and regional styles when constructing your answer.**
   - Soprano is a type of classical female singing voice with the highest vocal range of all voice types. The word "soprano" comes from the Italian word sopra (above),

which is the highest pitch human voice, often given to the leading female roles in operas. Not only women participated in this role but also men can do it.

- Alto is meaning "high" in Italian, which is the second highest part in the song and usually lead by female voice type. It is commonly combined with other voices in a song.
- Tenor comes from the Latin word tenere, which means "to hold". It is a type of classical male singing voice whose vocal range lies between the countertenor and baritone voice types. Tenor is also considered as one of the highest male voice types. Its roles in opera usually have a darker tone.
- Bass lowest male voice and has the lowest tessitura of all the voices. The wide variation in range and quality of bass singers based on cultural influence and individual variation.

5. **Choose four musical instruments, each instrument representing one of the four families of instruments. Describe the physical appearance and how sound is produced for each instrument, and what the most common use of each instrument is in music.**
   - Guitar belongs to string family instruments. They are usually made from wood and the strings are made of steel or nylon. The sound is produced from hollow wood and six strings. The players play guitar by plucking the strings with the fingers and fingernails of the right hand or left hand (if they are left hand players), or a small pick (called plectrum). Guitars are used for many types of music such as pop, rock, country, jazz, blues, etc.
   - Trumpet is a family of bass instruments. It has three keys called valves on a looped tube that ends in a bell shape. These valves help the player to change the pitch in a song. The trumpet is played by blowing into the mouthpiece and making a "buzzing" sound. It oftens used mainly in classical music and jazz music.
   - Flute is associated with woodwind instruments but flute is made of metal. The players make a sound by blowing their breath over the edge of the hole of the flute's head. Whenever they need to change the pitch of the flute, they can simply press the buttons (holes) or change the direction of the breath. The breath also can change the tone or the volume. Flute can be combined with violin and piano in a song.
   - Timpani, also known as kettle drums, is a family of percussion instruments. It has a skin-like material stretched over large copper bowls. Timpani are unique from other drums because they are tuned to certain musical notes. They are played by striking the drumhead with a special stick called a timpani mallet. The timpani is used in many types of ensembles, including marching bands, orchestras, concert bands, and rock.

6. **This is an activity question. For 1/2 to 1 hour this week, you are to pay attention and write down the music you hear; watch TV for one show or go to the mall for a little while and walk around to listen to all the music. Notice how much music is a part of EVERYTHING we do. Now, after you've written down what you heard, provide a detailed summary of what you found out. Do you notice a pattern of aggressive music if you are watching a sporting event (even in the commercials)? Is there a lot of percussion and brass, electronic sounds, or? Was there any pattern at all, or just random? Write about what you heard.**
    - On Monday, I had dinner at my uncle's house and we got a chance to watch a basketball competition on TV. The music was so aggressive and intense when the players were coming out of the basketball court. As they scored a point to the basket, the cheering sound, or music from the speaker played. There was not so much percussion or brass sound and I noticed that it was a random pattern because the players performed differently when they got a score or they missed.